Unit 1 - Communication and Employability in IT
Assignment 4

Introduction

As part of my continuing professional development (“CPD”), my careers advisor has asked me to complete a personal development plan. The plan is a tool to help me understand my personal strength and area for development, which will then be used to help me work towards long term and short term goals related to my career in ICT.

Long term objectives and goals

Details of your long term career objective. This should be your strongest and most favoured job role.

My long term career objective is to find a career in the IT industry, most preferably, as a robotics engineer. This is my most favoured job because I’ve always had a passion for engineering and futuristic hardware such as robots. I also believe that this job type could also be a good use for my creativity.

My strongest area in jobs is the creative and design side of the IT industry, the creative side or the hardware side benefits me more than the technical side is because cluttered work such as coding in the technical area isn't my strongest area in IT.

The strongest jobs for myself would be video game designer (This job is very difficult, but with passion and determination it could be completed), digital product designer and animator.

List three medium term goals you would need to achieve in order to meet your long term objective.

In order to meet my long term goals, I need to have medium term goals to put me in a position that will put me on my long term goals and achieve a career in a forward-moving company with solid performance and future projections. These 3 medium term goals consist of:

- Complete my first and second year in level 3 ICT with a grade goal of DDD, or at least a MMD in order to get in a decent university. I could also do Level 3 mathematics so I have a better chance of getting into a university.

- During college I could find part-time jobs so I can build up work experience and to update my CV, resume, etc. This would increase the chance of getting employed.

- Get into a decent university and get a Ph.D. in computer science or program in robotics so I could get a job in the IT industry and possibly get my preferred job career.

Assessing my strengths and areas for improvement

Details of two significant objectives you are currently working towards, i.e. Qualifications or Work Experience you are doing.

The two significant objectives which I am currently working towards to consist of: The Level 3 IT course so I could get an extended diploma in IT so I could go to university to get into computer science or program in robotics; The iGCSE english course to get a better grade so I could increase the chance in getting into university.

Identify at least five strengths you have that can help you to achieve your planned objectives in Part 1.

The five strengths that I have which can help me achieve the planned objectives in part 1 are:

- Determination
- Self-Motivation
- Team work
- Creativity
- Tolerance

I believe that these are my five strengths which can help me achieve my planned objectives on part 1. Determination is a strength because I have a passion in achieving my goals and not giving up easily. Self-motivation is a strength because I can motivate myself to produce enough work to complete my Level 3 IT qualification.

Teamwork is a strength because during college or at a job I could work with people to get better ideas or to give better ideas. Creativity is important, especially for the workplace, because it helps produce original ideas and work content. Tolerance is a strength because it means that I am understanding and patient in achieving my goals.

Identify at least five areas of development you think you need to improve in to achieve your planned objectives in Part 1.

The five areas which I believe that I need improvement on to achieved the planned objectives in part one are:

- Confidence
- Time management
- Organisation
- Planning
- Independence

I believe that these are my weakness and that I need improving on them so I could achieve my goals on part 1 a lot better. Confidence is a weakness for me because it takes a while to get used to the people around me, and there are moments in which talking to people can help solve problems or help understand something I am worried about. Time management is a weakness

for me because I don't have a schedule and I could end up not being punctual or end up wasting time by using too much free time, this means that the time to do work would be messed up and confusing.

Organisation is a weakness for me because I don't manage a lot of things and it could lead to confusion and misplacement, even of work and assignments, which could lead to disasters. Planning is a weakness for me because I don't arrange my schedules or work which, like organisation, could lead up to misplacement of work or time.

Independence is a somewhat weakness for me because I could work well when i'm alone, but being independent when around people is a big weakness for me because I could easily get distracted by others and produce less significant work that I would do when I am completely alone in a room.

Options and short term goals

Provide five short terms goals that you may need to consider on a weekly or monthly basis. These should support you in improving your development areas and achieving medium term goals and current activities.

The 5 short term goals I will use to improve my development areas with achieving my medium term and long term goals are:

- Manage my time better
- Keep my CV updated
- Stay away from stressful situations
- Finish my assignments earlier
- Reduce anxiety and stress

I picked these 5 short term goals because I believe that these are the biggest priority for me in my college career. I made these into short term goals because I believe that these are the goals that I could complete in the shortest amount of time compared to the other goals I had mentioned in the medium and long term. These goals could also help me achieve my medium and long term goals a lot easier

Rate each of your short term goal in order of importance, prioritise them in that order to see how and when you may tackle them.

Short term goals	Order of importance (1 being the highest and 5 being the lowest)
Manage my time better	2
Keep my CV updated	4

Stay away from stressful situations	5
Finish my assignments earlier	1
Reduce anxiety and stress	3

My action plan - to assist in making my goals achievable and realistic

For each of your short term goals, create a short plan to make the targets SMART:

SMART		Goals				
		Finish my assignments earlier	Manage my time better	Reduce anxiety and stress	Keep my CV updated	Stay away from stressful situations
Specific	Who? What? When? Which? Why?	My goal is to complete the assignments earlier when I am given them and complete it until at least 3 days before the deadline so I can reduce the stress and increase the quality of the work.	My goal is to manage the time better so that I could do each activity on the day in order and that I attend college in time so I can increase my punctuality and reduce time wasting.	My goal is to reduce the anxiety and stress when doing work by doing calm activities and that I balance my free time and work time so that I could concentrate better and produce better work.	My goal is to update my CV by updating it in 2 months or in a 2 week schedule so I can use it for employment or other purposes such as applying for a university.	My goal is to reduce the income of stress by going to quiet and clean places when doing work so I can reduce stress while working and increase work quality.
Measurable	How will I know when it is	I will know when this is accomplis	I will measure my progress	I will measure my progress	I will know when this is accomplis	I will know this is accomplished when I

	accomplished?	hed when I have finished the assignment before its deadline.	by checking the schedule and the time to see if they sync properly.	by checking my stress and anxiety when doing my assignments.	hed when I have completed my CV within the 2 week schedule or in 2 months.	have found a place where I could work properly without getting stressed from noise and unease.
Attainable	How to achieve the short term goals	In order to complete this short term goal I need to be determined to do the assignments as early as possible.	To achieve this goal I need to have a daily schedule on a planner or on a device.	To achieve this goal I will have to take regular breaks between work or do work earlier prior to the deadline.	To achieve this short term goal I have to update my CV on a scheduled time.	To achieve this goal I have to find a good quiet and clean working area to do my assignments.
Realistic and Relevant	Importance of achieving the short term goal and whether I am willing and able to achieve it.	To make this realistic I would have to make the priority to finish at least 3 days before the deadline. The importance of this is so I don't leave work for the last minute and stress takes over the	To make this goal realistic I would have to give myself enough time for work, free time and other essentials such as sleeping and eating. The importance of achieving this short term goal	To make this goal realistic I would have to calm down over time instead of only doing it before an assignment. The importance of achieving this is so that all the anxiety and stress doesn't get in the way	To make this realistic I would have to schedule the CV in a time where it doesn't interfere with other activities, such as every 2 weeks or in 2 months. The importance of this short term goal is so	To make this goal realistic I would have to choose a place where it is better to work than other places instead of finding the perfect stress free location. This is important because having little to no

		workload, which often replaces common sense and/or the understanding of the work, which produces bad quality work.	is so that I have an organised schedule and a proper flow of work and time.	of a good quality work, with stress and anxiety I would just focus on completing it instead of providing good quality.	that the CV gets updated for employment or even university applications. Updating it constantly could help put down key skills or activities that may be forgotten.	stress could impact the output of work significantly, and if I work in a place that causes little to no stress my work output would be much better than if I had a lot of stress.
Time based	When the short term goal has to be achieved	This short term goal has to be achieved when I get get given an assignment with a due in date.	This short term goal has to be achieved within approximately 2 weeks.	This short term goal isn't a very time based goal but it can be completed as soon as possible, which would take weeks or even months.	This short term goal can be achieved within 1 to 2 months from today, but it can be constantly updated every 2 weeks if scheduled.	This short term goal could be completed within a day or, at most, a week.